Compiled Product–Centric Software Engineering Organizational Structures

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization

Overview: This page conveys the typical structure of a product-centric delivery organization and leadership roles.

Product Categories

Share interrelated product lines to coordinate roadmaps. Also known as value streams, customer journeys or experiences.

Product Lines

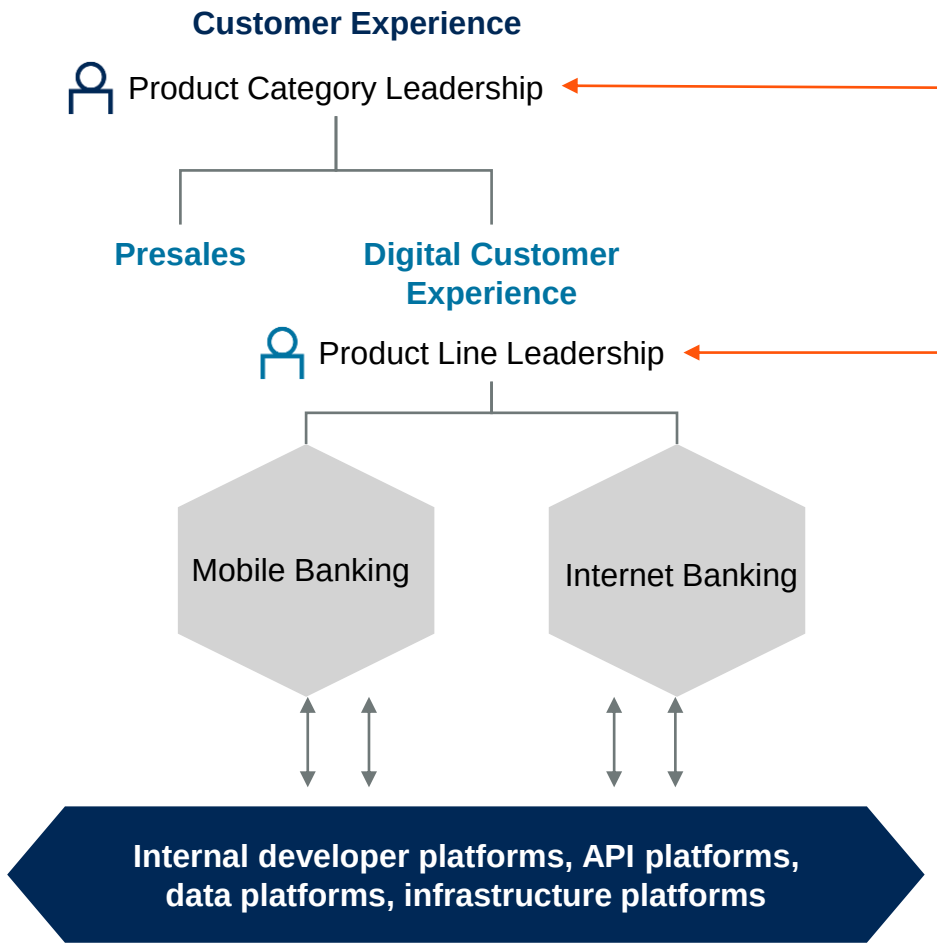
Consist of one or many interrelated business capabilities. Also known as groups, families or tribes.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Deliver and support a capability or outcome for internal or external customers. Also known as multidisciplinary teams, stream-aligned teams, scrum teams, agile teams, digital hubs, pods or squads.

Foundational Products

Provide cross-cutting solutions to address individual products' evolving needs and enterprise goals. Also known as platform teams or digital foundations.



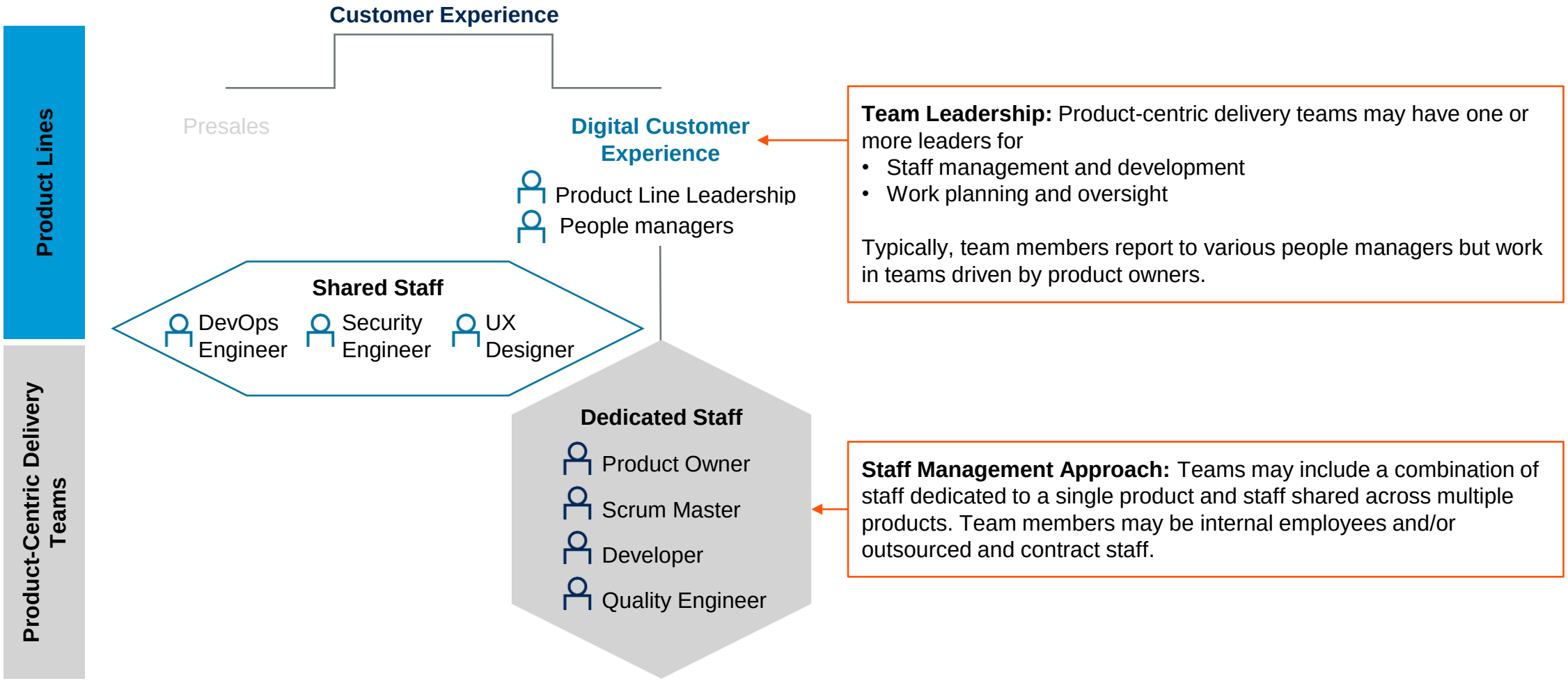
Product category leader (aka, senior product manager or senior delivery leader) manages one or more interrelated product lines.

Product line manager (aka, product managers, product portfolio managers or program managers) provides management and technical oversight to interrelated product teams.

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting

Overview: This page conveys the typical composition and reporting structure of a product-centric delivery team.



Team Leadership: Product-centric delivery teams may have one or more leaders for

- Staff management and development
- Work planning and oversight

Typically, team members report to various people managers but work in teams driven by product owners.

Staff Management Approach: Teams may include a combination of staff dedicated to a single product and staff shared across multiple products. Team members may be internal employees and/or outsourced and contract staff.

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Examples of Product-Centric Delivery Organizational Structures

Organization Name	Product Alignment	Industry	Revenue as of 2024 (in US$)
Aon	• Business capabilities • Customer capabilities	Professional Services	$10B-20B
Ford	• Business capabilities • Customer capabilities	Automotive	Over $100B
Globo	• Business capabilities	Media	$1B-5B
HealthPartners	• Business capabilities	Health Insurance	N/A
Isbank	• Business capabilities	Financial Services	$1B-5B
National Board of Medical Examiners (NBME)	• Customer journey • Business capabilities	Medical Services	N/A
Neami National	• Business capabilities • Customer capabilities	Healthcare	Under $1B
Premera Blue Cross	• Business capabilities	Health Insurance	$1B-5B
Registers of Scotland	• Business capabilities • Customer capabilities	Government	N/A
Vanguard	• Customer journey	Financial Services	$5B-10B

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization — Aon

Product Categories

Aon has multiple product categories or “solution lines” that support business and customer capabilities.

Product Lines

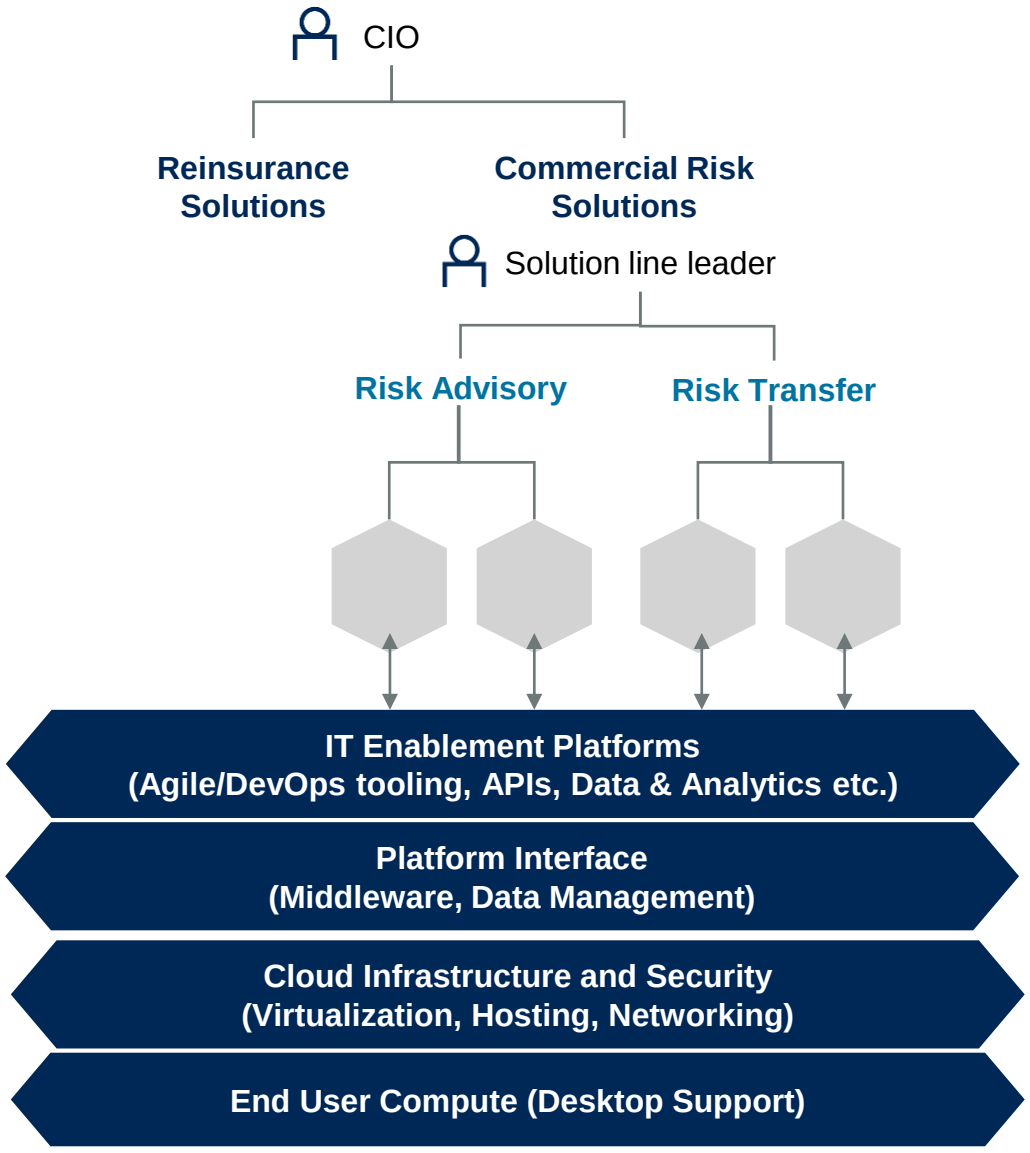
Each product category has one or more product lines.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has one or more product-centric delivery teams.

Foundational Products

Foundational technology platforms provide support to all product-centric delivery teams across solution lines.

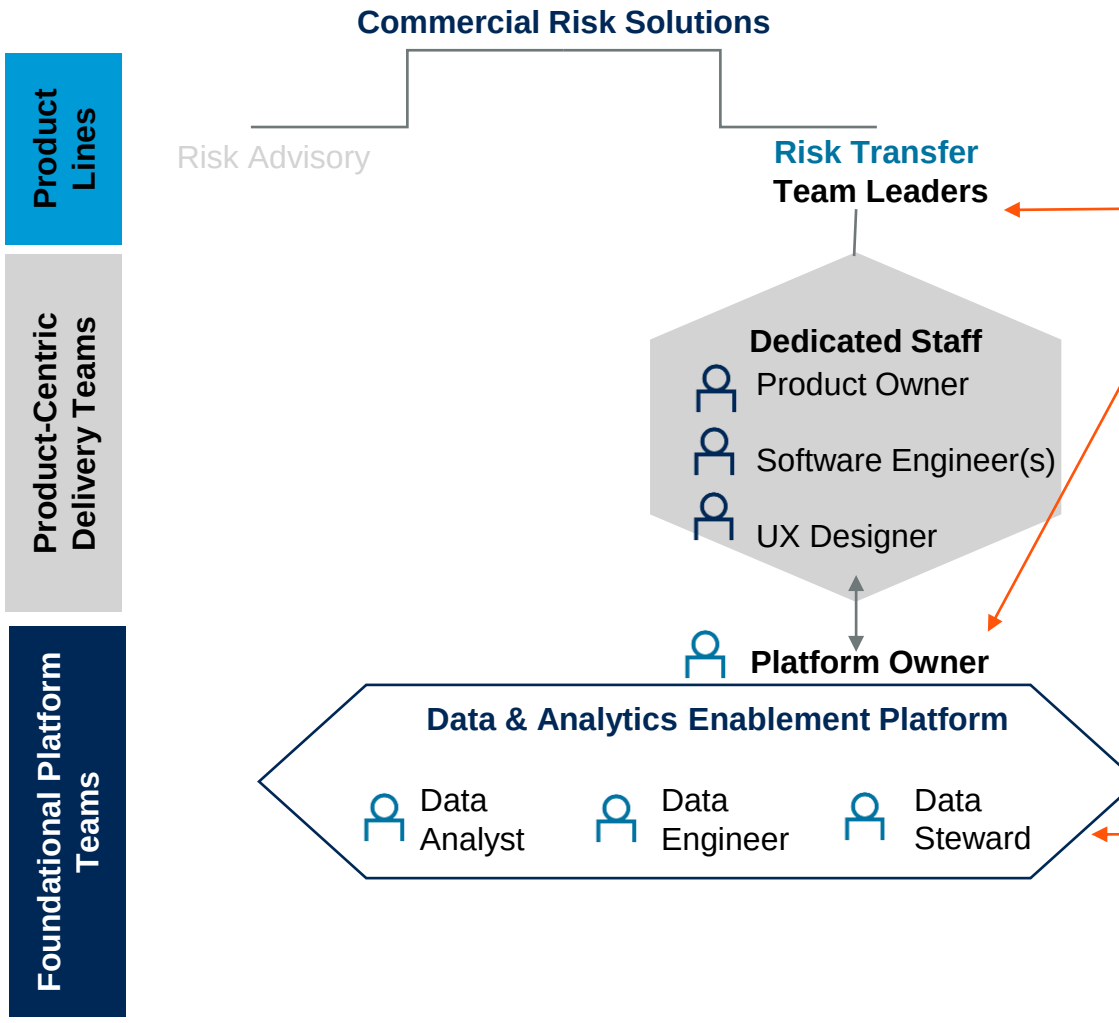


Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Professional Services
Revenue: $13.38 B (2024)
Employees: 50,000+ (2024)
% IT work delivered in product model: 100%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — Aon



Team Leadership: Product-centric delivery and platform teams have different leaders who work together to deliver solutions:

- Product-centric delivery team leaders are responsible for product teams' work planning and oversight.
- Platform owners own the capabilities roadmap for their platform and are responsible for prioritizing demands from different product lines based on their strategic importance.

Foundational Platform Teams

- Aon's platforms aim to reduce friction in product-centric team workflows. Platform capabilities are scoped based on the needs and personas of end users in product-centric delivery teams.
- Recognizing that platform teams sometimes struggle to see how their work contributes to overall business objectives, Aon orients each team as a link in value creation. This approach enables platform teams to see how their work creates value for product teams, and ultimately for the end customer.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization– Ford Motor Co.

Product Categories

Ford has eight product-driven organizations (PDOs) with over 140 product groups or categories that support business and customer capabilities.

Product Lines

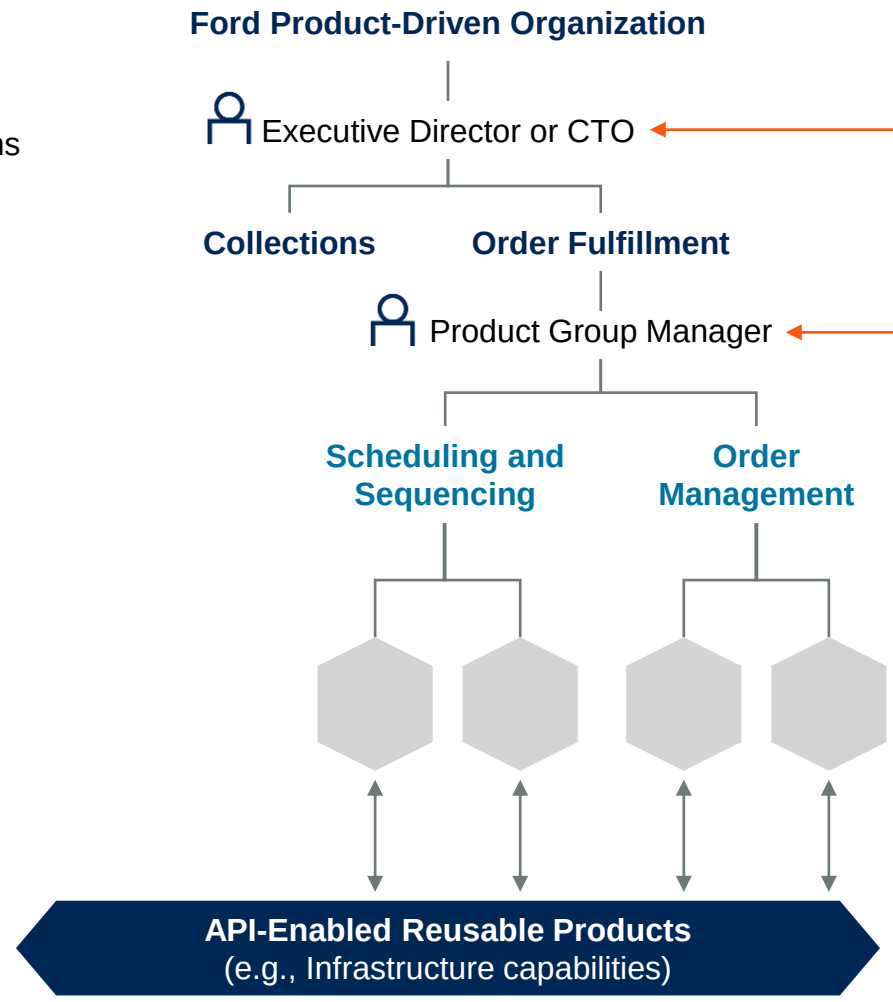
Ford collectively has over 330 product lines with each product group having one or multiple product lines.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has between four to 20 product-centric delivery teams.

Foundational Products

Foundational products are API-enabled reusable products that provide support to product-centric delivery teams across all PDOs.



Each PDO has a **CTO or Executive Director** who oversees engineering for all product groups in partnership with their product owners in the Ford business functions.

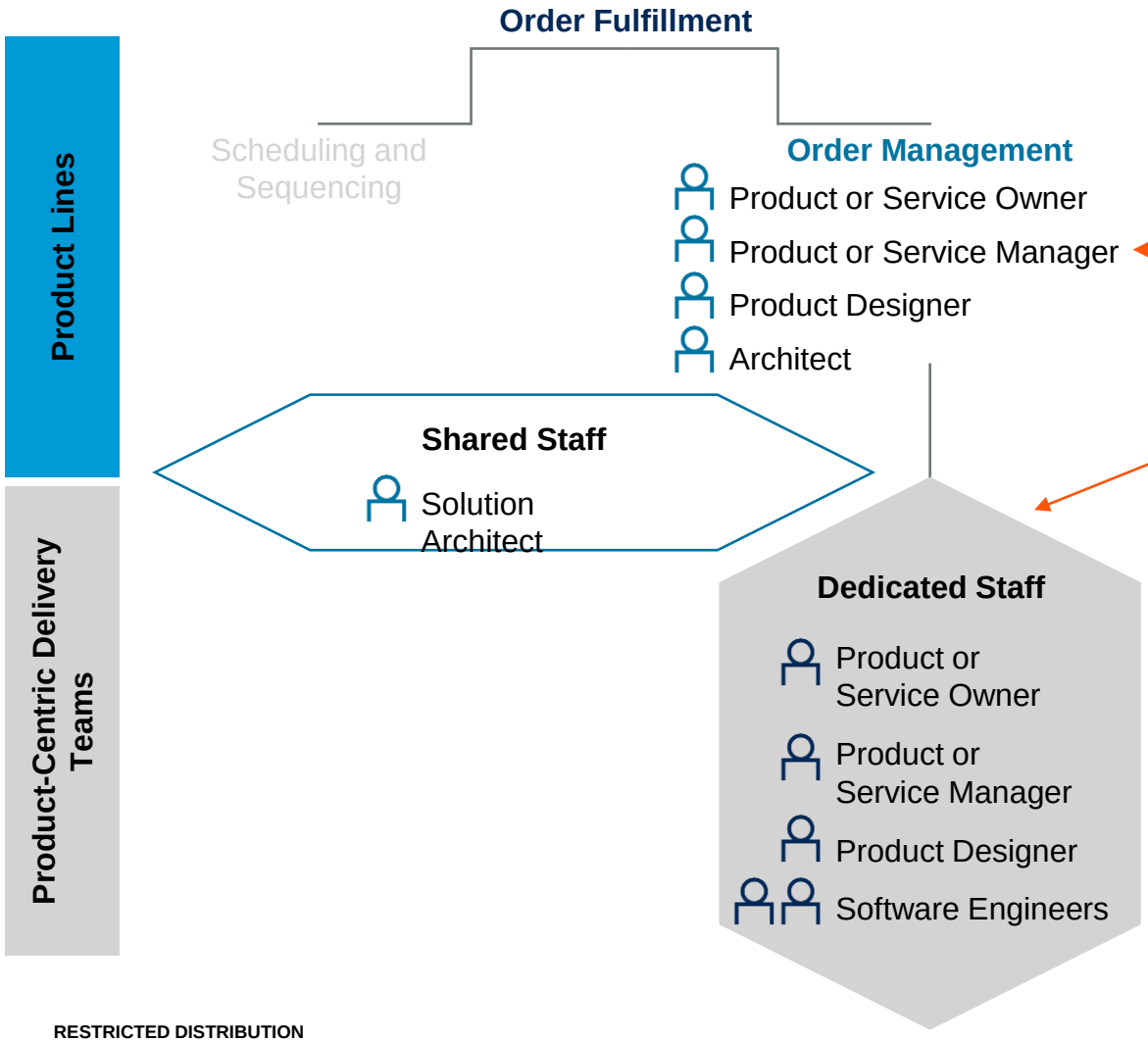
Product group managers are aligned to product groups and are responsible for driving the roadmap and strategy of all product lines in that group.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Automotive
Revenue: $136B (2021)
Employees: 183,000+ (2021)
% IT work delivered in product model: 100%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — Ford Motor Co.



Team Leadership: Ford follows a team-based structure at all levels across the product model. Each product line has **four leaders representing different domain perspectives** present on each product-centric delivery team, i.e., product or service owner, product or service manager, product designer and architect.

- All four leaders are jointly responsible for work planning and oversight for all product-centric delivery teams in their product line.
- Each leader manages the performance and talent development of roles within their domain in the product line. For e.g., the product designer at the product line level develops all product designers across teams in their product line.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- Team Size: 8-12 members
- Delivery Approach: Integrated best practices from different agile frameworks

Staff Management Approach:

- Each product-centric delivery team has the same set of dedicated staff: product or service owner, product or service manager, product designer and software engineers. However, data-driven products may also have a dedicated data engineer or data scientist to support their needs.
- Shared staff such as solution architects support multiple product lines.
- Teams employ contract resources where necessary to support changing demands and need for non-differentiating capabilities, with some teams employing up to 100% contract staff.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization — Globo

Product Categories

Globo's digital hub has three product categories or "value streams" to build digital solutions and services.

Product Lines

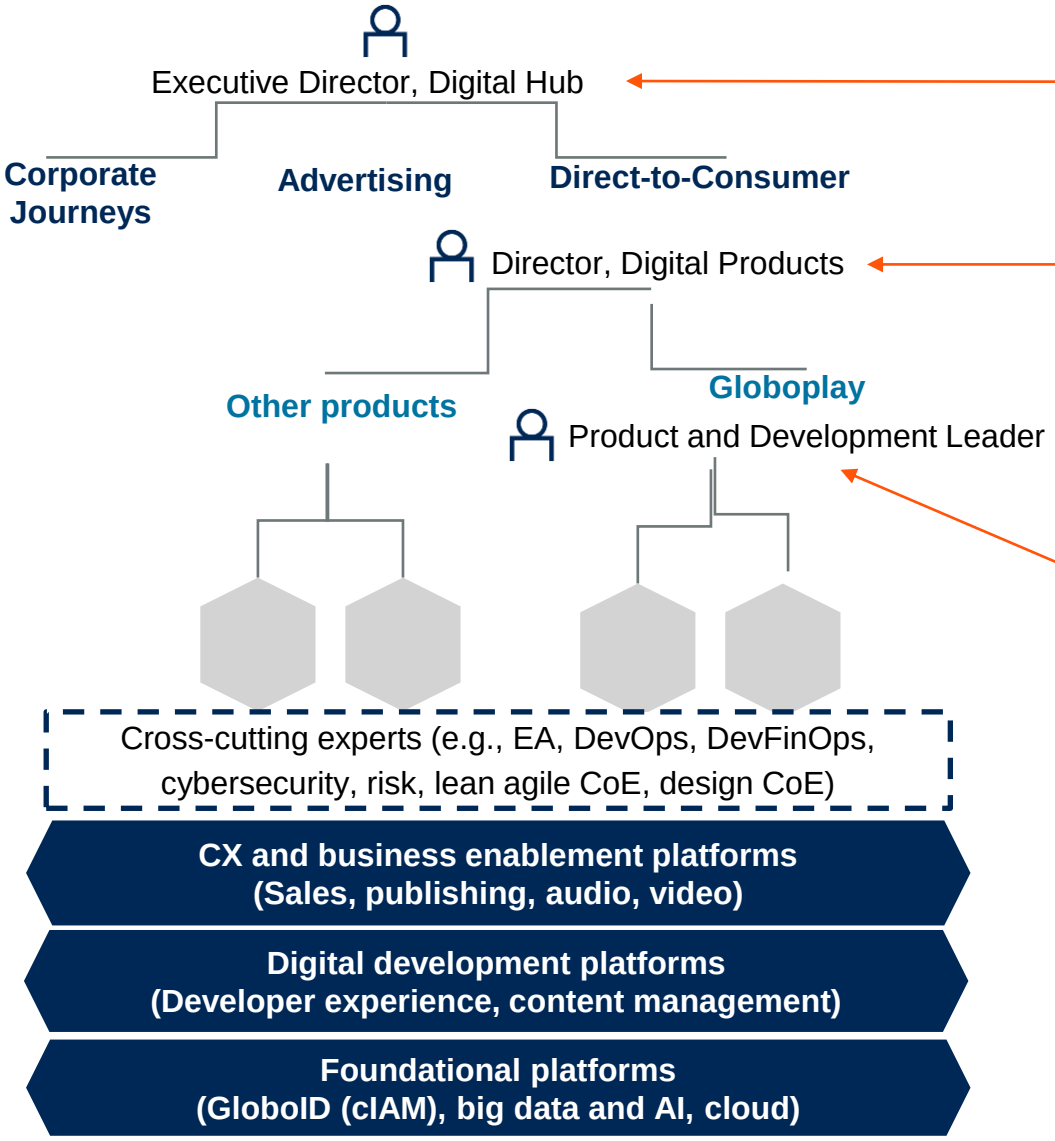
Each value stream has multiple product lines or "programs" which house interrelated product teams and provide management oversight, allowing for efficient prioritization and resource allocation.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line is divided into user journeys. Each user journey is supported by a tribe, which has multiple "squads." Cross-cutting experts help all squads adopt agile ways of working, adhere to architectural and security standards and foster knowledge sharing.

Foundational Products

Platforms provide all product categories with tools and components to build secure, consistent and cost-efficient digital solutions.



The executive director is responsible for the vision, technology strategy and business strategy alignment of all product categories for Globo.

Directors, aligned to each product category, are responsible for driving the roadmap and strategy of all product lines in that category.

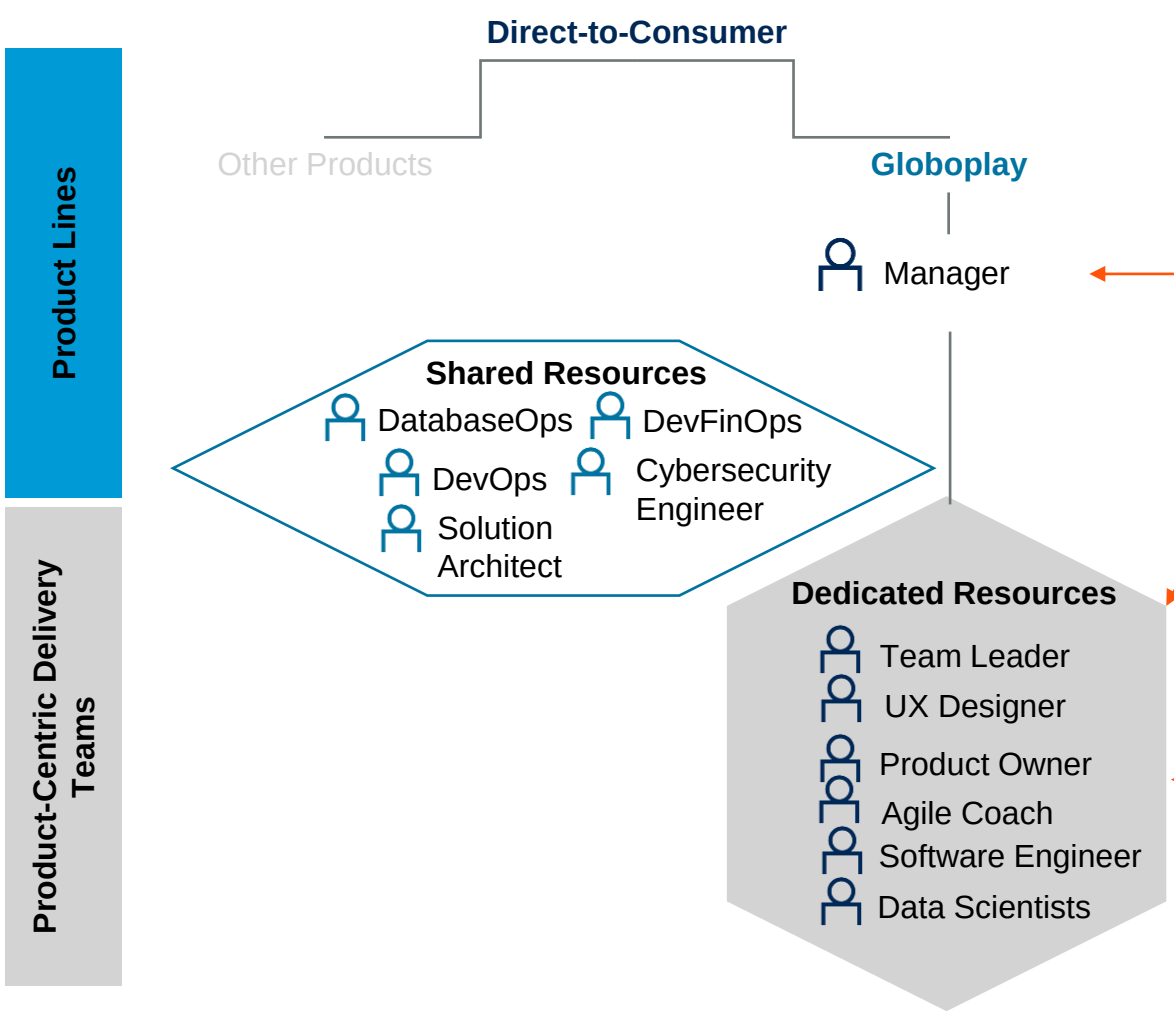
Product and development leaders are responsible for managing the work of all squads and tribes in their product line.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Media
Revenue: $3B (2023)
Employees: 14,000+ (2023)
% IT work delivered in product model: 70%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — Globo



Team Leadership: Product-centric delivery teams have two separate leaders for managing work and skill development:

- Group Product Managers or tribe leaders are responsible for setting the vision of the tribe and overseeing work of all squads within their tribe.
- Each technical member of every squad is also aligned to their respective technology manager (e.g., iOS), to build capabilities and skills.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- Team Size: 8-15 members; varies based on the complexity of the business challenge they support
- Delivery Approach: Agile

Resource Management Approach:

- Squads are multidisciplinary fusion teams comprising a mix of both IT and business subject matter experts.
- Each squad supports a user journey of the product, with a couple of squads positioned horizontally to support cross-cutting business challenges of the product line.
- Core delivery staff stay aligned to one squad, while experts such as cybersecurity engineers rotate and distribute knowledge and expertise across squads.
- At any point, each squad has all the skills and roles necessary to support end-to-end evolution of the product.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization — HealthPartners

Product Categories

HealthPartners has four product categories aligned to business capabilities that support critical business objectives.

Product Lines

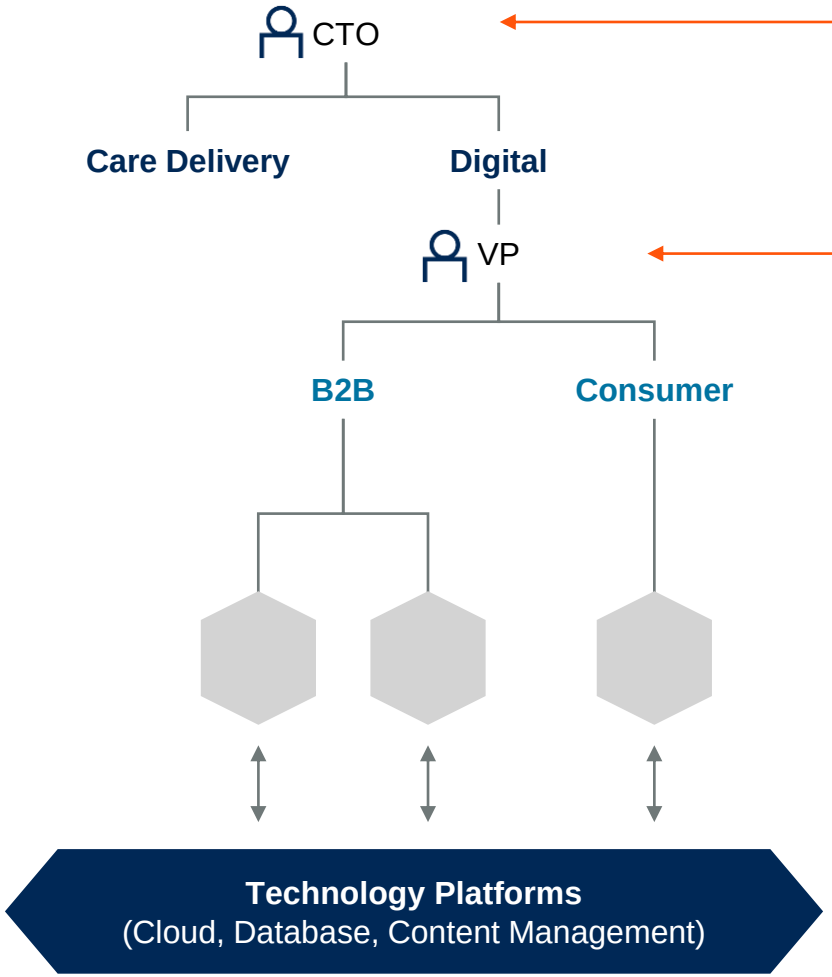
Each product category has between two to four product lines.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has one or more product-centric delivery teams.

Foundational Products

Foundational technology platforms provide support to all product-centric delivery teams.



The **CTO** oversees the work of all product categories and partners with executives from the business to build the technology strategy that supports the business strategy.

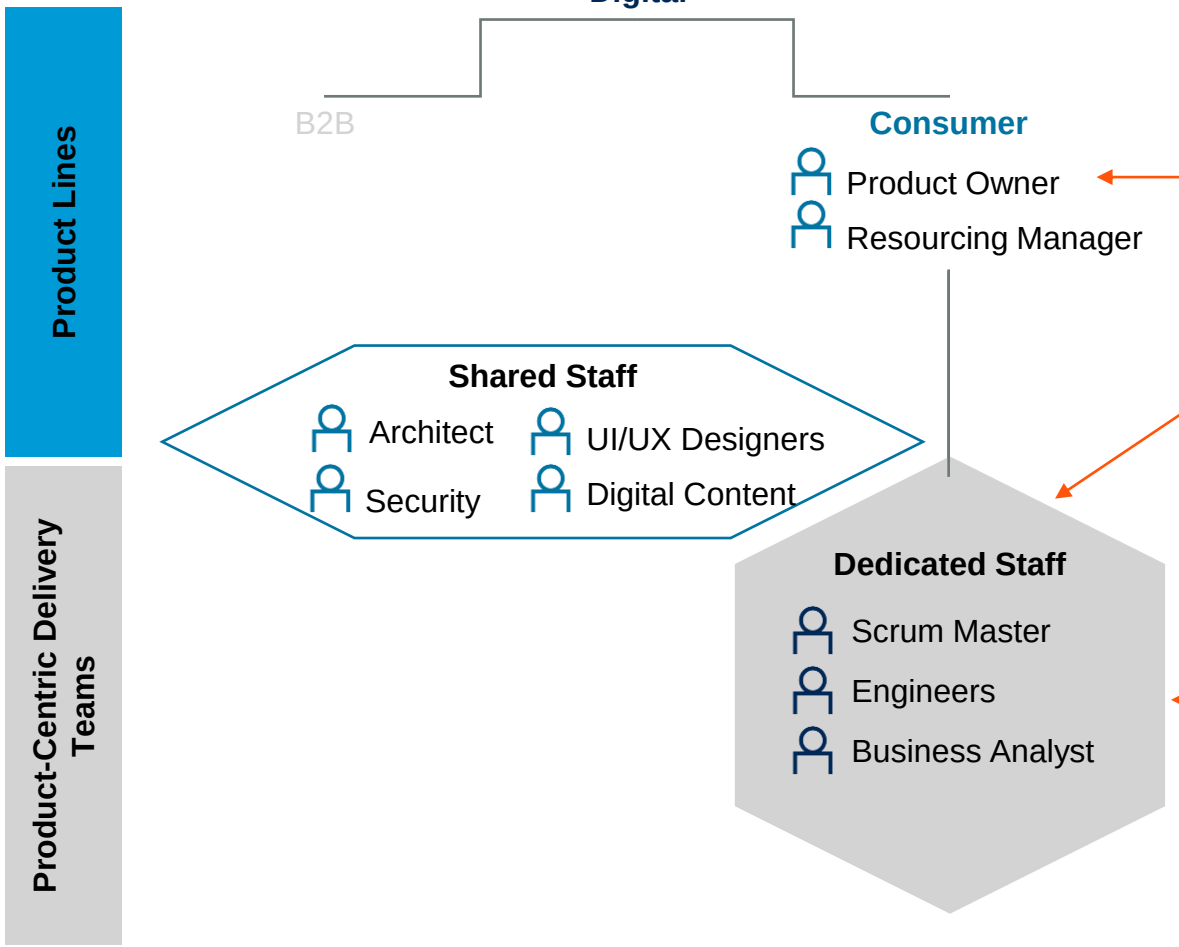
VPs aligned to product categories are responsible for driving the roadmap and strategy for all product lines in that category, together with business leaders.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Health Insurance
Revenue: N/A
Employees: 26,000+ (2022)
% IT work delivered in product model: 60%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — HealthPartners



Team Leadership: Product-centric delivery teams have two separate leaders for managing work and talent development:

- **Product owners** are often sourced from the business and are responsible for product vision and teams' work prioritization, planning and delivery coordination.
- **Resourcing managers** are responsible for team management and development and eliminating barriers in the team's work.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- Team Size: 8-12 members
- Delivery Approach: Agile

Staff Management Approach:

- Dedicated staff include a product owner, scrum master, business analyst and engineers, including test engineers and software development engineers. Depending on team size and workload, product owners and Scrum Masters can support more than one related product teams.
- Shared staff such as architects, UI/UX designers, security and digital content support multiple product teams.
- Some product-centric delivery teams may employ contract staff to support requirements for additional capacity.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization — İşbank

Product Categories

Işbank has two product categories aligned by banking customer segments and banking services.

Product Lines

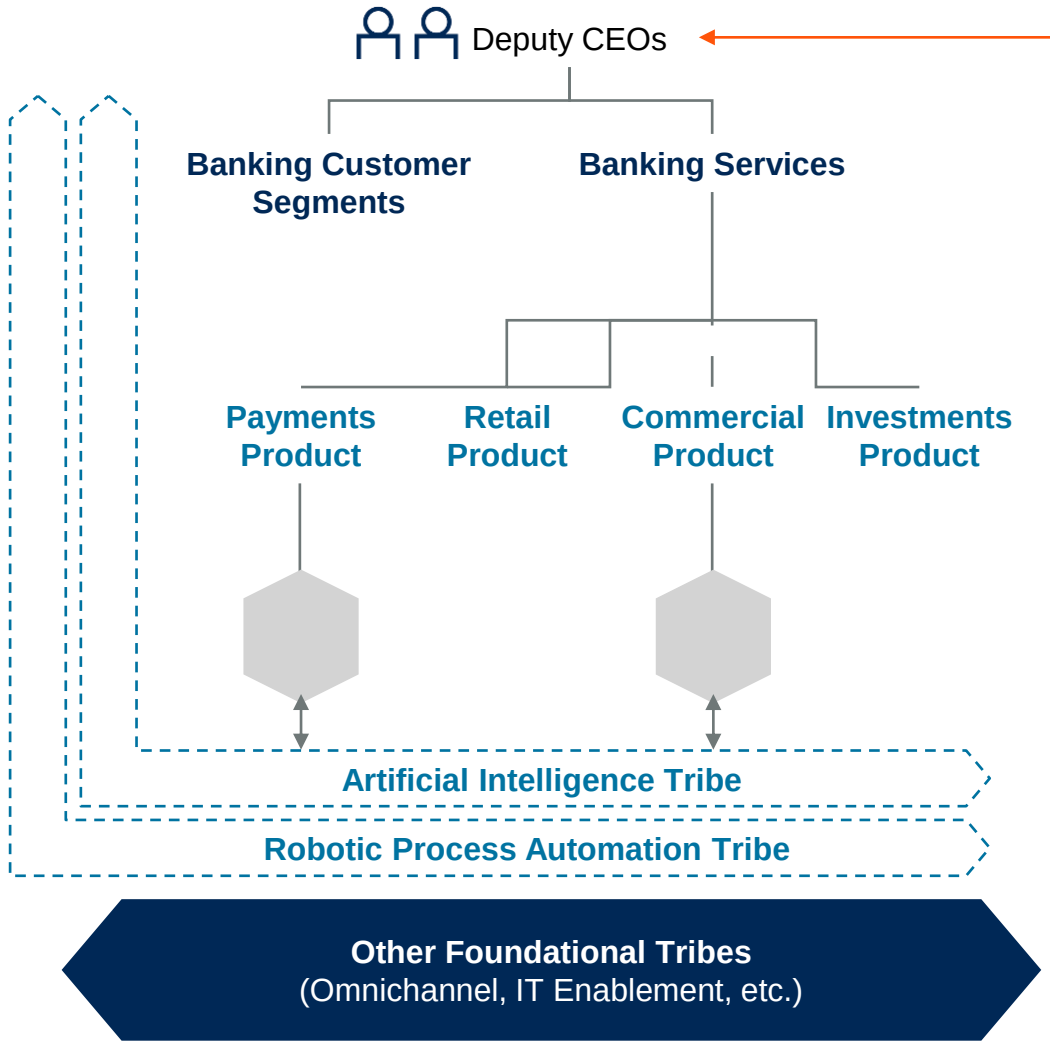
Each product category has between one and four product lines or tribes.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has multiple product-centric delivery teams or squads.

Foundational Products

Digital foundations such as AI and RPA tribes support both “end-users” as well as other product-centric delivery teams or squads, while others support only squads. These digital foundations are themselves organized as “tribes” that create tools and platforms for other squads.



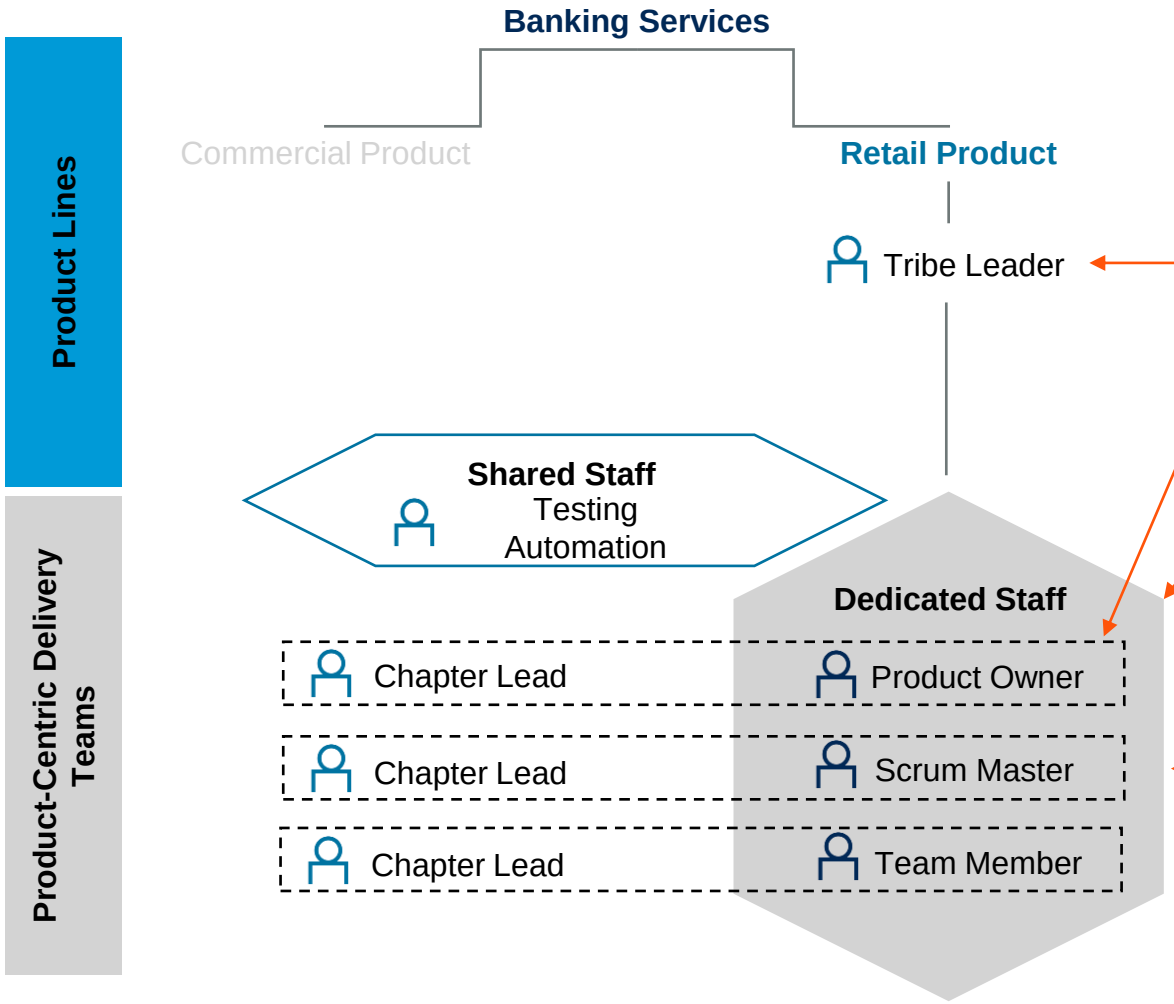
Deputy CEOs are aligned to product categories or product lines within a product category and are responsible for driving the vision and strategy for the product line and for managing cross-tribe dependencies.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Financial Services
Revenue: $3.5B (2021)
Employees: 22,802+ (2021)
% IT work delivered in product model: 55%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — İşbank



Team Leadership: Product-centric delivery teams have two separate leaders for managing work and skill development:

- **Tribe leaders** are responsible for setting the vision of the tribe, resourcing, and oversight of all product-centric delivery teams or squads within their product line or tribe, as well as cross-tribe interdependency management.
- Each member of every squad is aligned to a chapter, headed by a **chapter lead**, to build their capabilities and skills**.** The alignment of team members to specific chapters is a joint decision by the tribe leader and the chapter lead.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- Team Size: 7-10 members
- Delivery Approach: Spotify-like

Staff Management Approach:

- Product-centric delivery teams are multidisciplinary fusion teams comprising a mix of both IT and business staff. Team composition varies by outcome and expertise, and flexes based on the backlog.
- Dedicated staff maintain a ratio of 30% IT staff to 70% staff from other parts of the business. All dedicated staff in a squad are referred to as “team members” rather than using separate role titles.
- Shared staff such as testing automation support all product-centric delivery teams or squads in a tribe.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization– National Board of Medical Examiners (NBME)

Product Categories

NBME has two product categories around business capabilities and key steps in the customer journey.

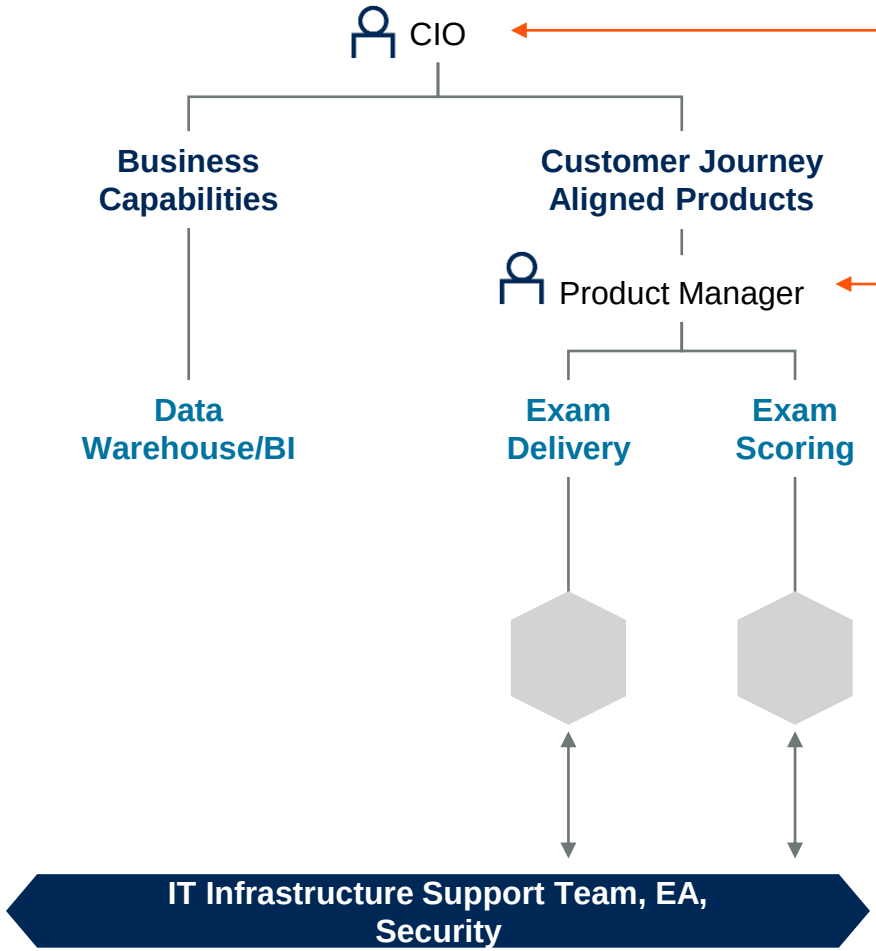
Product Lines

Each product category has between one and four product lines.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has one dedicated product-centric delivery team.

Traditional IT functions support all product-centric delivery teams through foundational capabilities and business enablement technology projects.



A single CIO oversees the business strategy and work of all product categories.

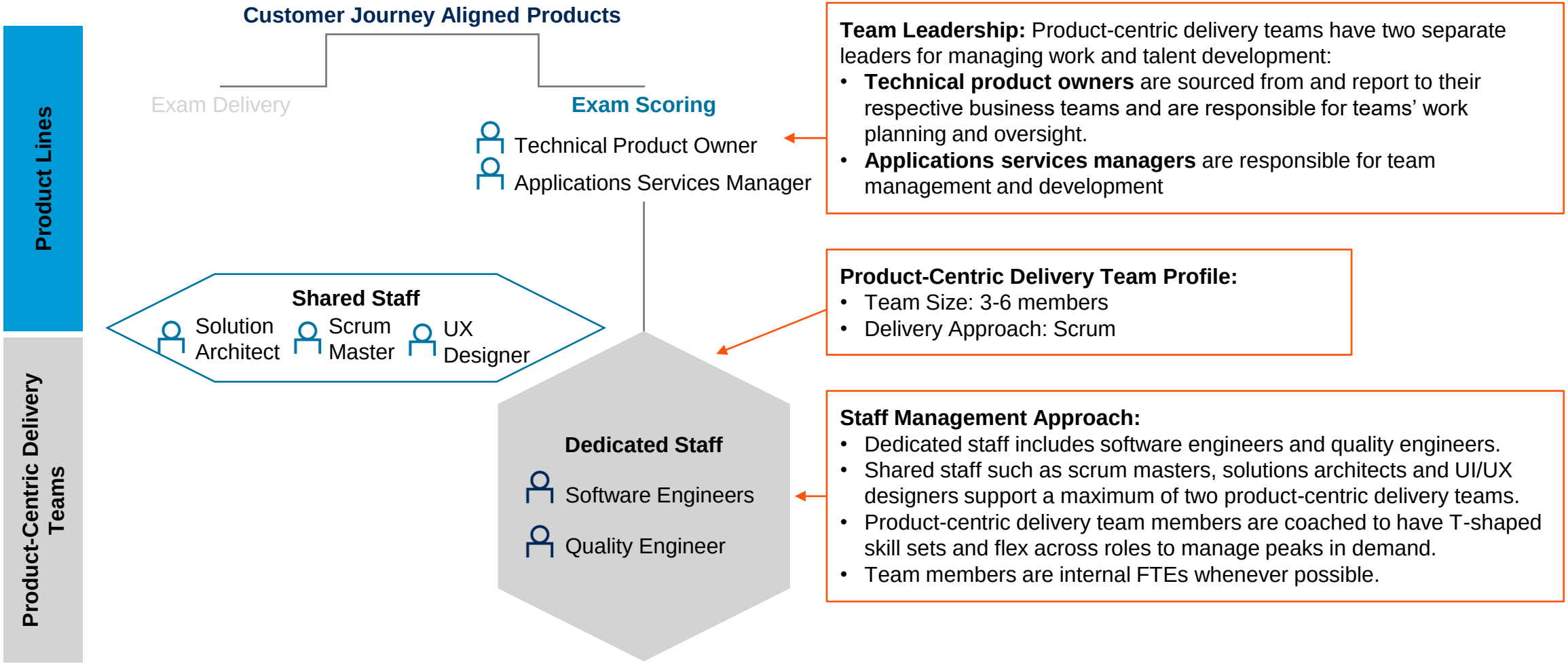
Product managers aligned to each product category work closely with the technical product owners of each product within the category to translate their customer strategy into technical capability roadmaps and prioritize the backlogs.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Medical Services
Revenue: N/A
Employees: ~500 (2021)
% IT work delivered in product model: 70%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — NBME



Team Leadership: Product-centric delivery teams have two separate leaders for managing work and talent development:

- **Technical product owners** are sourced from and report to their respective business teams and are responsible for teams' work planning and oversight.
- **Applications services managers** are responsible for team management and development

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- Team Size: 3-6 members
- Delivery Approach: Scrum

Staff Management Approach:

- Dedicated staff includes software engineers and quality engineers.
- Shared staff such as scrum masters, solutions architects and UI/UX designers support a maximum of two product-centric delivery teams.
- Product-centric delivery team members are coached to have T-shaped skill sets and flex across roles to manage peaks in demand.
- Team members are internal FTEs whenever possible.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization — Neami National

Product Categories

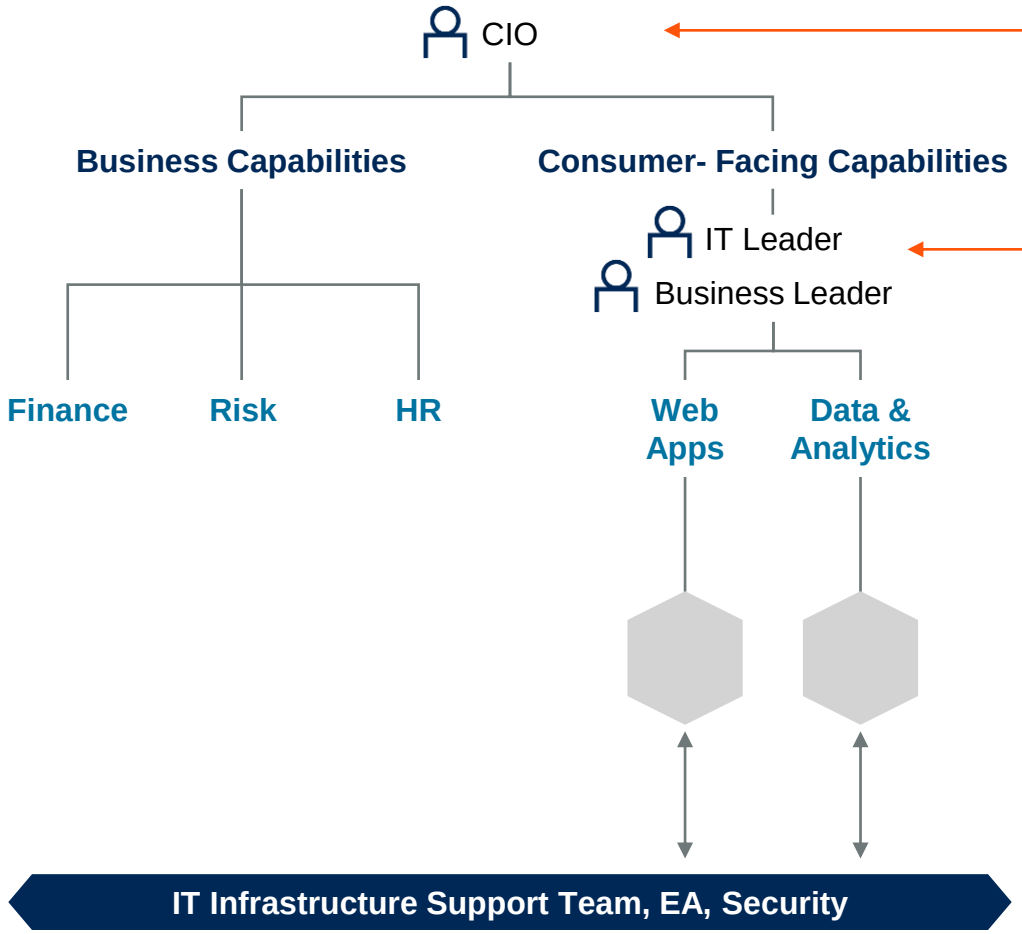
Neami National has two product categories around customer capabilities and business capabilities.

Product Lines

Each product category has between one and four product lines.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has one product-centric delivery team, but one team can support more than one product line.



A single CIO oversees business strategy and outcomes of all product categories.

Business and IT leaders jointly set the roadmap, strategy and resourcing of all products in each product category.

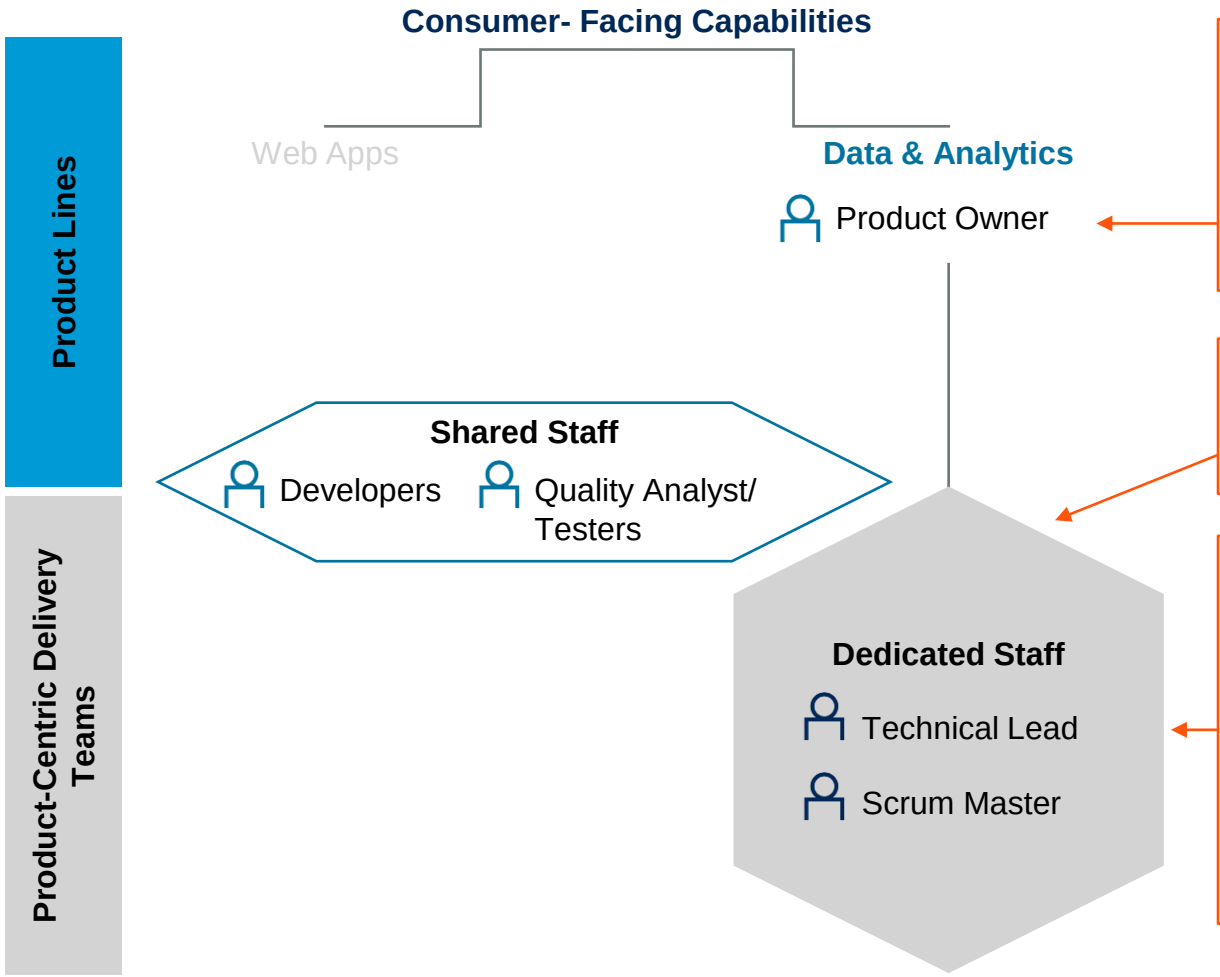
Traditional IT functions support product-centric delivery teams through foundational capabilities and independent projects.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Healthcare
Revenue: $100M (2021)
Employees: 1000 (2021)
% IT work delivered in product model: 50%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — Neami National



Team Leadership: Product owners are usually sourced from business teams and are responsible for work planning and oversight for their product-centric delivery teams. While Neami presently doesn't have designated roles for team management, they leverage key people in existing IT leadership positions that have prior talent management experience to mentor and coach teams.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:
- Team Size: 3-6 members
- Delivery Approach: Scrum

Staff Management Approach:
- Dedicated staff include a product owner or a coalition of product owners (where the product is aligned to more than one line of business), a technical lead and a scrum master.
- Shared staff include delivery resources such as developers and testers, who are aligned but not fully dedicated to a product and support multiple products.
- Technically astute business employees are added to manage peaks in demands.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization — Premera Blue Cross

Product Categories

Premera's product portfolio is organized around nine capability product groups (CPGs) that support specific business outcomes.

Product Lines

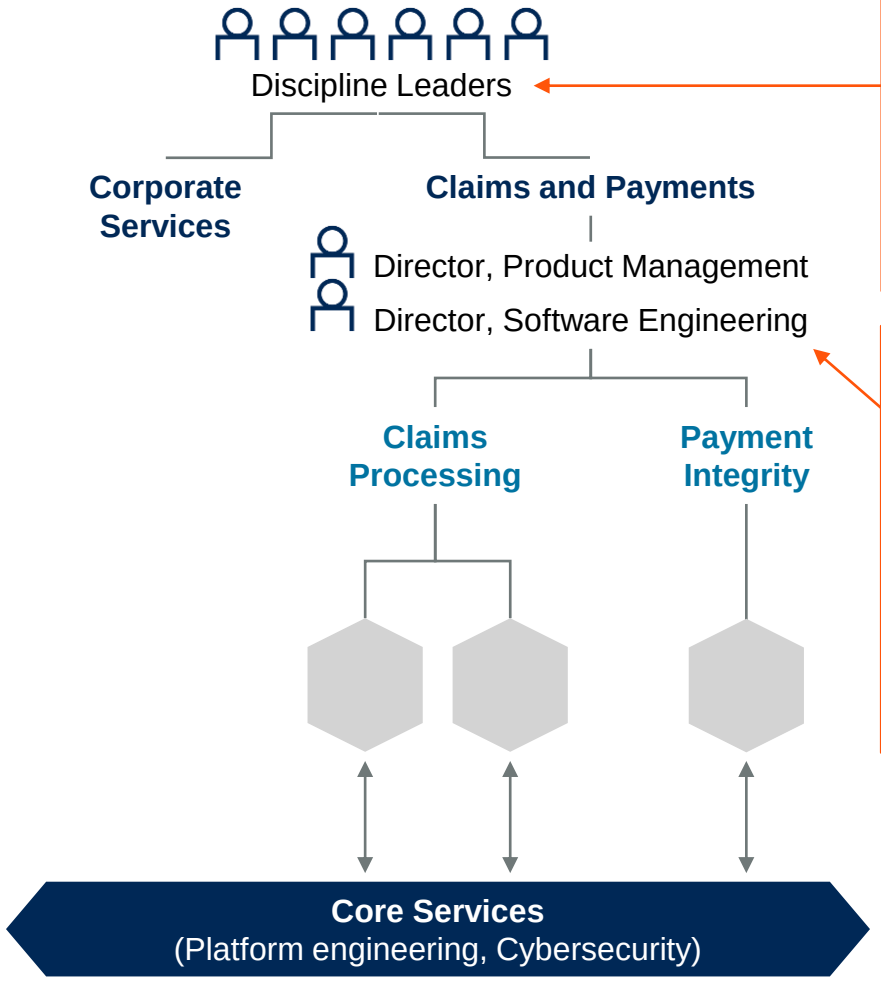
Each CPG has four to twelve product lines.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has one to ten product-centric delivery teams.

Foundational Products

Foundational products are also organized as CPGs, working in the same way as other CPGs with their primary customer being other CPGs..



Premera has a leadership group aligned to six disciplines, i.e., product management, enterprise architecture, software engineering, cybersecurity, platform engineering and program management, that manage their respective workforce, skills, and practices, and together oversee strategy, sequencing and delivery of all CPGs.

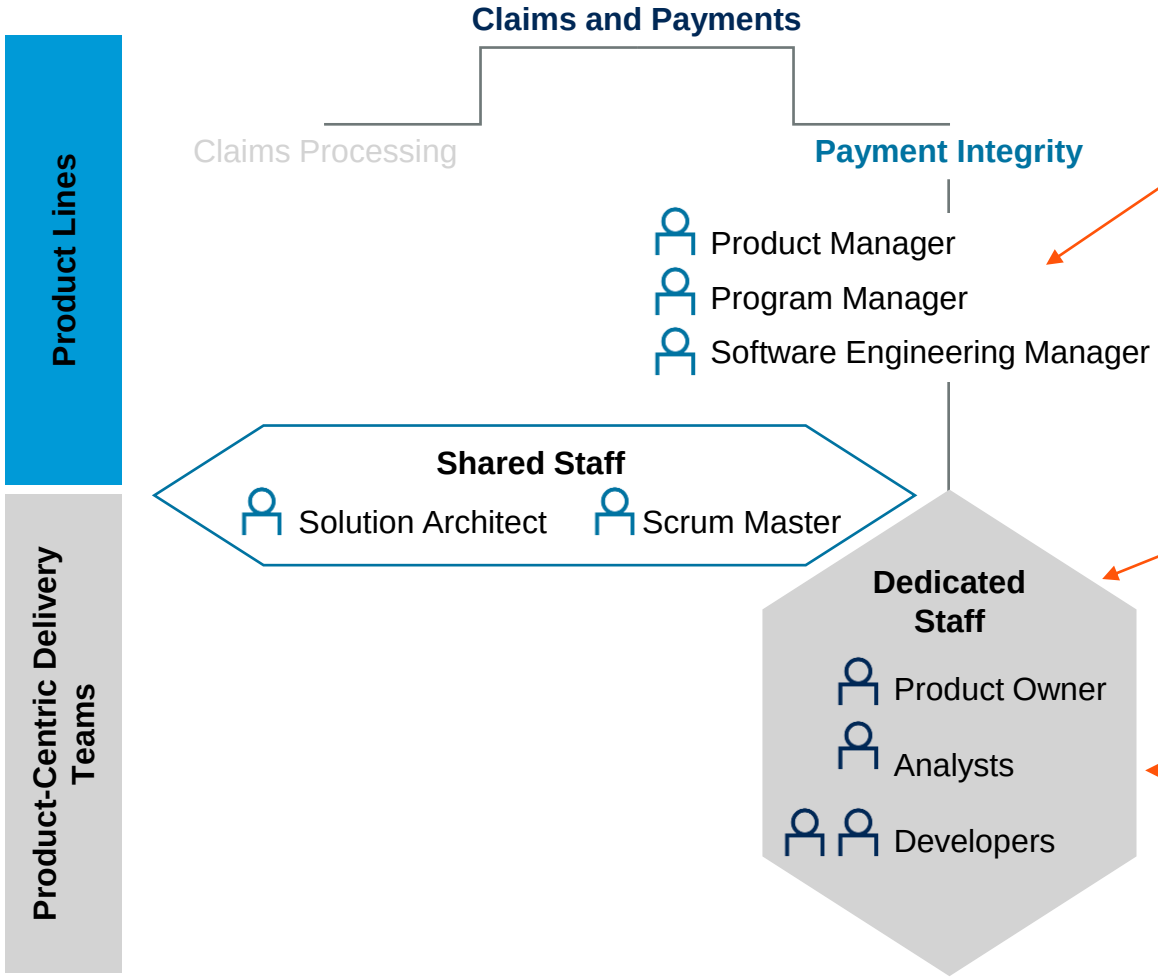
Each CPG is managed by representatives from different disciplines based on the needs of the product lines in the CPG. These representatives are together responsible for defining outcomes and KPIs, sequencing the roadmap, managing cross-CPG dependencies, and overseeing the strategy, resourcing and delivery of all product lines in their CPG. Directors are responsible for one or more CPG based upon size and complexity.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Health Insurance
Revenue: $5B (2021)
Employees: 3200 (2021)
% IT work delivered in product model: 60%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — Premera Blue Cross



Team Leadership: Product-centric delivery teams have two separate leaders for managing work and talent development:

- Product managers are responsible for KPIs, roadmap and initiative and epic level definition. Product-centric delivery teams are responsible for feature and story level and work closely with other discipline managers to drive product delivery.
- Each discipline's manager is responsible for the performance and talent development of roles within their discipline for their product line. For e.g., product manager manages all the product owners and analysts across product teams in their product line, while the software engineering manager manages all developers in the product line.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- Team Size: 8-12 members
- Delivery Approach: SAFe

Staff Management Approach:

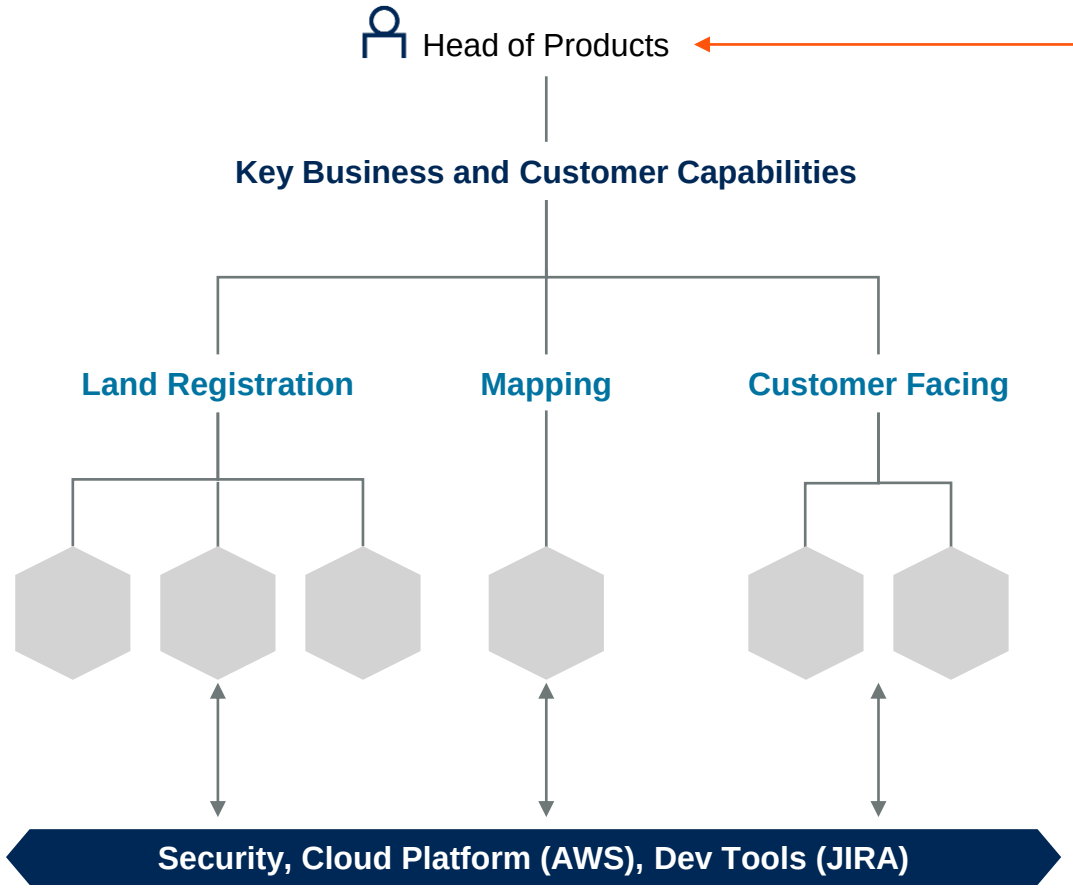
- Dedicated staff always include a product owner, analysts and developers, but teams may also have dedicated UX designers based on their product line's needs.
- Shared staff such as solution architects and scrum masters support multiple product-centric delivery teams within a product line.
- Product-centric delivery teams may employ contract resources depending on the team size, business needs and capacity requirements.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization–Registers of Scotland (RoS)

Registers of Scotland
ros.gov.uk

A single **head of products** oversees business strategy, delivery work and talent development of all product lines, and is part of the group of business leaders who provide governance across product lines.



Product Lines

RoS has six product lines or domains aligned to key business and customer capabilities.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has one to a maximum of three product-centric delivery teams.

Foundational Products

IT enablement platforms such as security, cloud, dev tools support all product lines. A technical product manager for development enablement (part of the IT Enablement team) works closely with the product lines and teams.

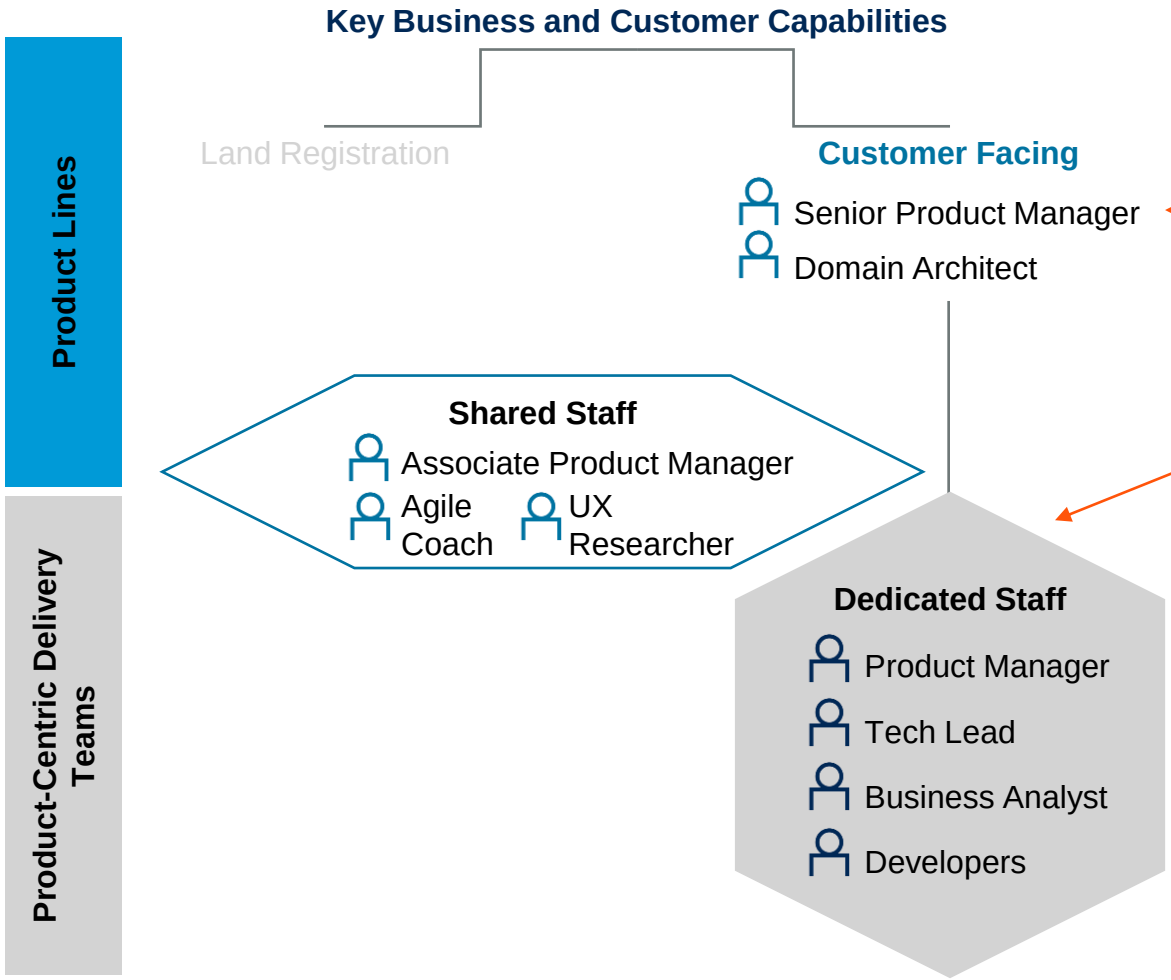
Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Government
Revenue: N/A
Employees: ~1100
% IT work delivered in product model: 70%

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Product-Centric Team Structure and Reporting–Registers of Scotland (RoS)



Team Leadership: Each product line has a senior product manager and a domain architect who are responsible for managing delivery and talent development:

- **Senior product managers** work closely with **domain architects** to prioritize outcomes, manage dependencies and align delivery with product strategy.
- **Senior product managers** also manage talent and performance development for all teams within their product line, and work with other senior product managers for knowledge sharing across product lines.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- Team Size: 6-9 members
- Delivery Approach: Product lines have agency to adopt approaches that best support delivery of their outcomes.

Staff Management Approach:

- Dedicated staff typically include product manager, tech lead, business analyst and developers, but can vary based on product specific needs.
- Shared staff such as associate product managers, agile coaches and UX researchers support a maximum of three products within a product line.
- Product-centric delivery team members are full-time employees wherever possible, but contract workers can be used to meet capacity requirements.

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Product-Centric Delivery Organization — Vanguard

Product Categories

Each Vanguard business unit has about four product categories aligned to core customer journeys.

Product Lines

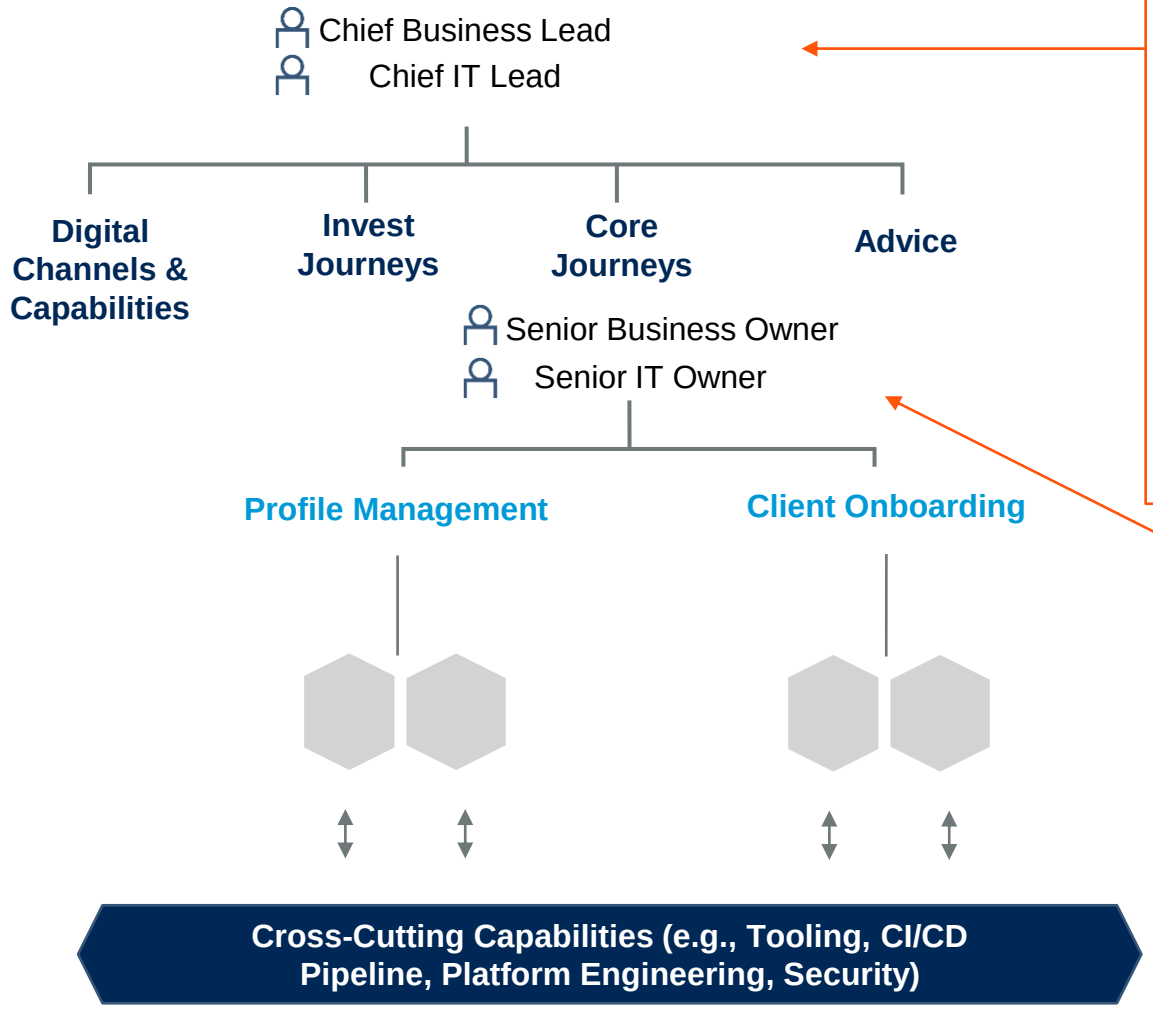
Each product category has approximately five product lines or families.

Product-Centric Delivery Teams

Each product line has between four and nine product-centric delivery teams.

Foundational Products

Foundational products support all product-centric delivery teams and are managed by approximately 50 different teams in the CTO and Security organizations.



Vanguard uses a “two-in-the-box” leadership model, in which each level of the product organization is co-led by a business leader and an IT leader. The entire product organization is co-led by a chief business lead and a chief IT lead, are jointly responsible for setting product strategy and overseeing delivery.

All product and business leaders ultimately report to the chief business leader, while all technical staff ultimately report to the chief IT leader.

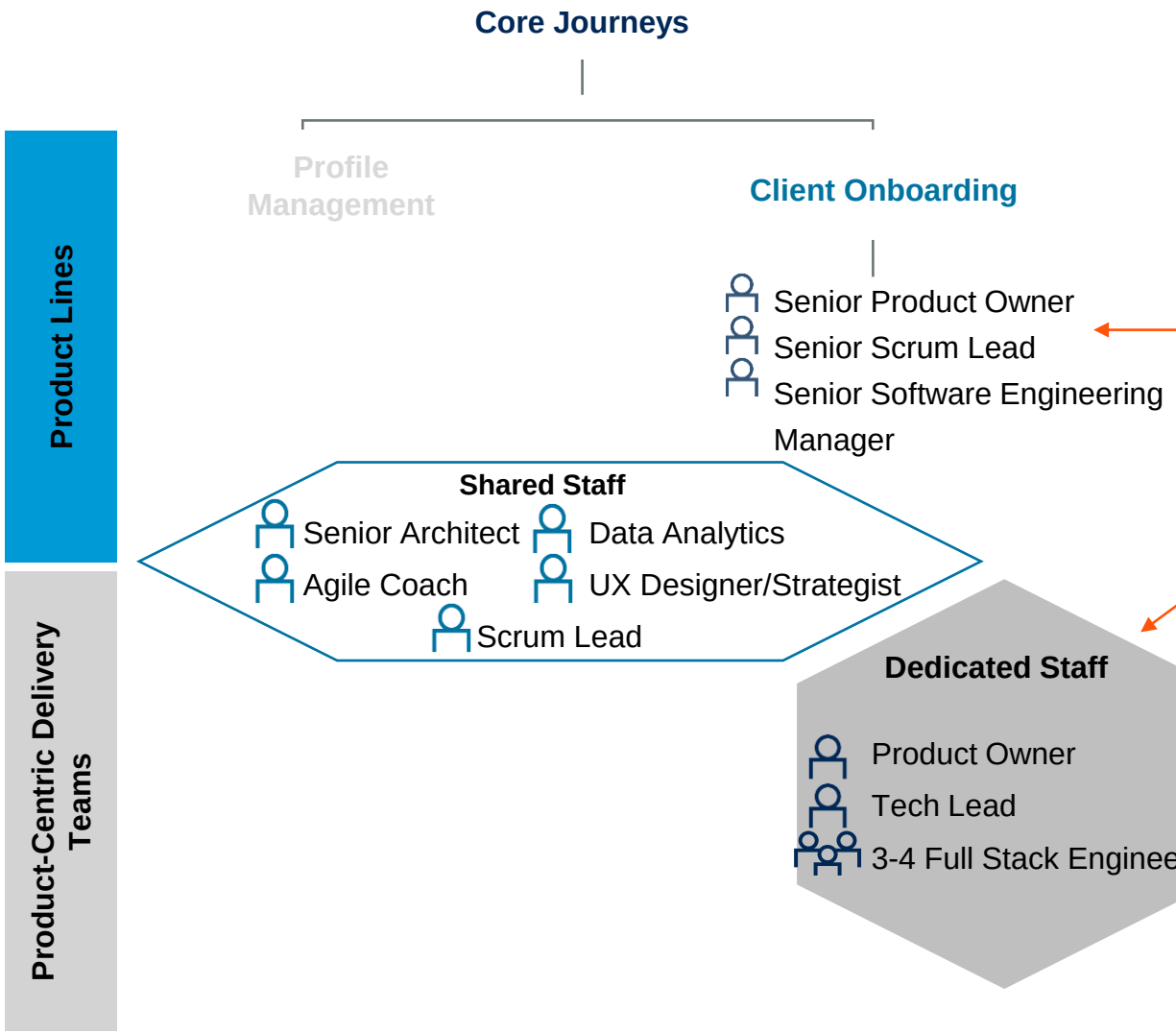
Each product category is similarly co-led by a senior business owner and a senior IT owner, who collectively set the strategic vision for their category in collaboration with their peers.

Enterprise Snapshot

Industry: Financial Services
Revenue: $6.9 Billion (2022)
Employees: 20,000 (2023)
% of IT work delivered in product model: 80-90%

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Product-Centric Delivery Team Structure and Reporting — Vanguard



Product line leadership includes:

- **Senior Product Owners**, who are responsible for understanding customer voice and setting the strategic direction for the product
- **Senior Scrum Leads**, who are responsible for managing work and ensuring their product is built quickly and efficiently
- **Software Engineering Managers**, who are responsible for overseeing the team's technical work

Other product line leaders include **Chapter Leads**, who are responsible for coaching, developing, and training engineers and each directly manage 2-3 engineers.

Product-Centric Delivery Team Profile:

- **Team Size**: 9-10 members
- **Delivery Approach**: Agile/Scrum

Staff Management Approach:

- **Dedicated staff** support each product's core capabilities. All teams include a product owner, tech lead, and 3-4 full-stack engineers. Other dedicated staff vary depending on product maturity and product needs. For example, early-stage products usually include additional resources such as a Scrum Lead, Data Analyst, and UX Designer.
- **Shared staff** support all product teams within one product category, including Senior Architects, Agile Coaches, UX Designers/Strategists, Data Analytics, and Scrum Leads.
- Contract workers are brought in as-needed to supplement Vanguard staff and typically serve as Full Stack Developers or UX Designers.

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